

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK

OPEN WORLD HACKATHON

Build the future of physical AI through believable worlds, data-minded social environments, and original experiments.

DATE

SATURDAY

25 JUL 2026

LOCATION

SAN FRANCISCO

3001 19th St

BUILD WINDOW

10:00 - 18:30

Submissions close 6:30 PM PT

MAKE A WORLD PEOPLE WANT TO ENTER.

Three tracks. One day. Up to \$10,000 worth in prizes.

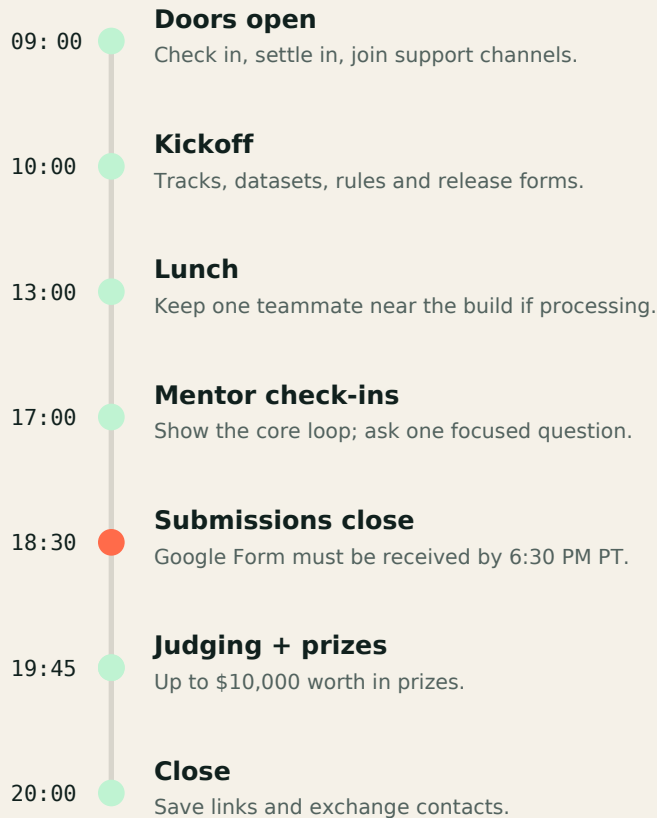


EVENT PAGE

<https://luma.com/ttc3tp9d>

Your day at a glance

Protect the final hour: get to a working Play Mode build early, then polish.



FIRST 60 MINUTES

- 0-10 min — choose one track
- 10-20 min — write the core interaction in one sentence.
- 20-35 min — open V-CTRL, choose a template or supplied map.
- 35-50 min — build the smallest playable loop.
- 50-60 min — test in Play Mode and assign owners.

SUGGESTED ROLES

Builder • Interaction/logic • Visuals •
Demo/submission

DEFINITION OF DONE

A judge can open it, understand it, and experience the core loop.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Runs without builder intervention | ☐ Shared world/build link + video demo submitted |
| ☐ Clear start, objective and end state | ☐ External assets and AI tools disclosed |

Three ways to build

Pick the track that best expresses your idea. Judging rewards a focused, complete experience.

01

TRACK

OPEN NARRATIVE

STORY + CHALLENGE

Build a believable real-world scenario or puzzle inside VLGE.

- Escape rooms, navigation challenges, training scenarios
- Use 3D Gaussian Splats or VLGE templates
- Prioritize atmosphere, clarity and a satisfying progression

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE: A stranger can enter, understand the goal, and finish.

02

TRACK

VLGE TOGETHER

SOCIAL + BEHAVIOR

Build a social or multiplayer world in Unity (preferred), VLGE, or another engine where interaction produces useful data for robotics, physical AI, or behavior modeling.

- Create meaningful cooperation, competition, coordination or shared exploration
- Identify the robotics/physical-AI use case and the behaviors or telemetry that could be valuable
- Design tasks and interactions so future sessions could produce useful, consented data; logging is optional

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE: The social interaction is purposeful and has a credible future data-collection use.

03

TRACK

FREE TRACK

OPEN EXPERIMENTATION

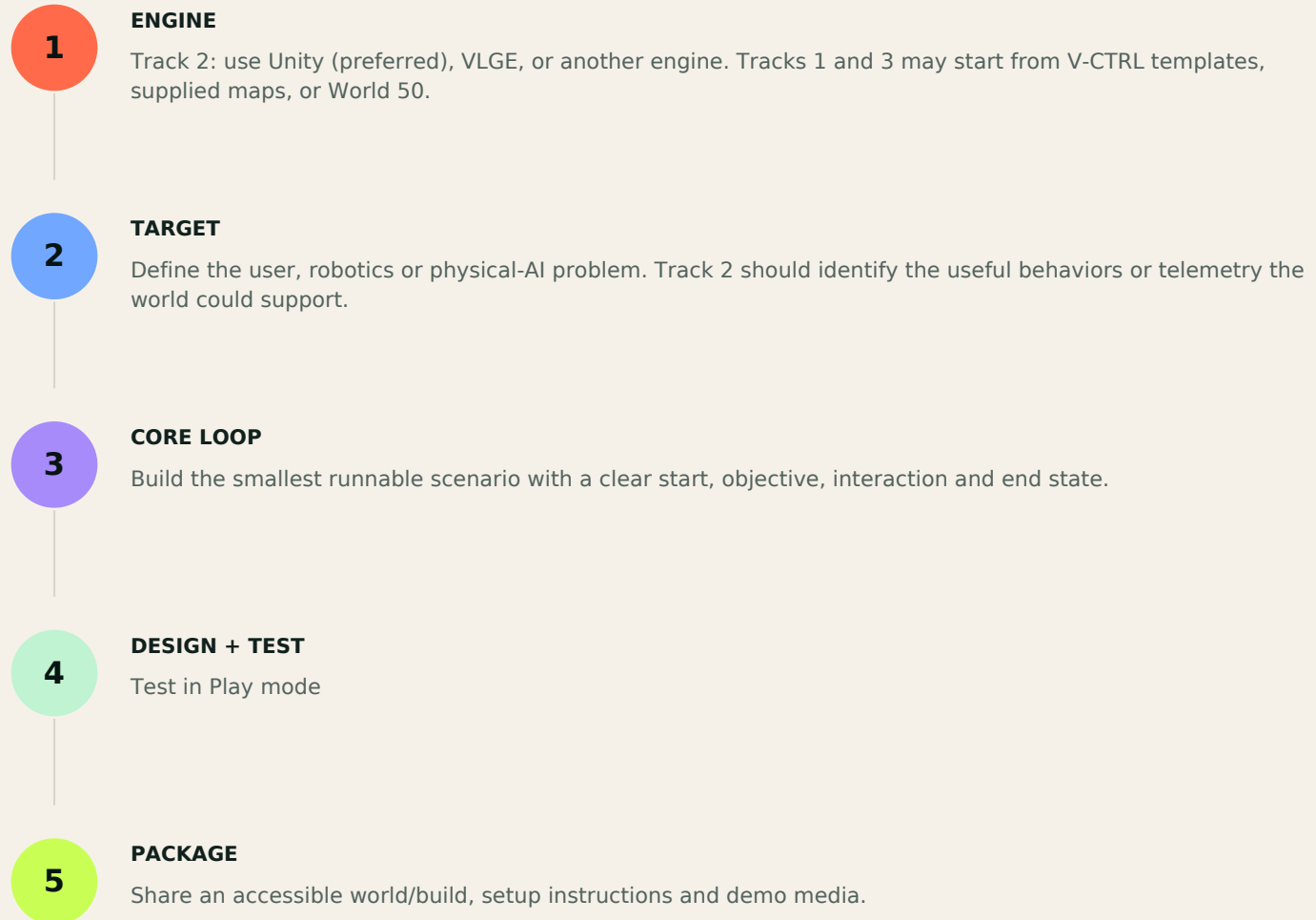
Push VLGE beyond the other tracks with an original use of its tools, data or features.

- World generation, behavioral telemetry, spatial capture
- Research demos, simulations, utilities or new formats
- State the hypothesis and show what your prototype proves

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE: The idea reveals a capability or use case we did not expect.

Choose the right build path

Track 2 may use any engine; Unity is preferred. Tracks 1 and 3 can build directly in V-CTRL.



VLGE BUILDER PATH

- World Builder basic layout
- Add an object + use the inspector
- Advanced asset types + model generation
- Add image, video, text or game
- Post-processing effects + Play Mode

UNITY + ROBOTICS LINKS: SEE PAGE 9.



V-CTRL

<https://vctrl.vlge.com>



VLGE GUIDE

<https://world.vlge.com/vlge-guide>

Optional: build from a real place

Gaussian Splatting can create a photoreal base world. Use supplied maps if processing time is risky.

PATH A / CAPTURE

Record your own location

- 4K / 30 fps; one continuous ~15-min clip
- Lock exposure, white balance and focus
- Use even light; run a test clip first
- Walk slow overlapping loops at low, mid and high heights
- Keep moving; do not spin in place

PATH B / USE SUPPLIED

Start from a prepared map

- 3 Gaussian Splat maps (.ply; large files)
- 3 standard 3D maps
- Edit and Play Mode assets included
- Use supplied maps/templates when speed matters
- Download only what you need

CAPTURE, MAP AND IMPORT LINKS + QR CODES: PAGE 9

IMPORT WORKFLOW

Video / photos → Teleport → VLGE

- 01 ZIP + UPLOAD** Create a Teleport account and upload the capture at get.teleport.varjo.com.
- 02 PROCESS + REVIEW** Generation may take roughly 2-4 hours. Review the result before continuing.
- 03 COPY SHARE ID** Open the splat info panel and copy the Teleport Share ID.
- 04 ADD TO WORLD 50** In VLGE, add a Splat object and paste the Share ID.
- 05 GENERATE COLLIDER** Wait for the world, generate its collider, then add VLGE assets and test.

TIMEBOX IT

If your splat is not ready or correct by mid-afternoon, switch to a supplied map or template. A working experience scores better than an unfinished capture.

Submission instructions

One form per team. The form must be received by 6:30 PM Pacific Time.

HARD DEADLINE

18:30 PT / SAT 25 JUL 2026

GOOGLE FORMS SUBMISSION LINK

<https://forms.gle/AgyhxvcXJGFNj9PC8>



REQUIRED SUBMISSION FIELDS

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Team name + participant names | ☐ Three strongest screenshots |
| ☐ Project title + track + engine | ☐ Setup / controls / expected outcome |
| ☐ One-sentence pitch | ☐ Track 2: future data-collection plan |
| ☐ Judge-accessible world/build link | ☐ External assets, datasets and AI tools used |
| ☐ 60-90 second backup demo video | ☐ Repo/notes + known device requirements |

DEFAULT DEMO FORMAT

3 minutes demo + 2 minutes Q&A

Lead with the playable experience: problem → interaction → outcome. Keep the backup video locally available. Organizers may adjust timing at kickoff based on submission count.

What the judges will reward

100 points total. Strong fundamentals beat ambitious scope that does not run.

25

POINTS

EXPERIENCE + USABILITY

Clear goal, intuitive controls, coherent flow, and a satisfying result.

25

POINTS

TECHNICAL EXECUTION

Stable build, reliable interactions, and thoughtful technical choices.

20

POINTS

TRACK FIT + IMPACT

Directly addresses the chosen track and creates meaningful value.

20

POINTS

ORIGINALITY

Distinct concept, surprising mechanic, or fresh use of spatial/behavioral data.

10

POINTS

DEMO + REPRODUCIBILITY

Concise story, judge-ready link, test instructions, and proper attribution.

TRACK-SPECIFIC LENS

Open Narrative: believability + progression

VLGE Together: social interaction + usefulness and feasibility of the data-collection concept

Free Track: clarity of hypothesis + platform-expanding insight

TIE-BREAKERS

- Working live build
- Stronger core interaction
- Clearer provenance
- Greater readiness to share

NO EXTRA CREDIT FOR UNUSED FEATURES.

Spend your last hour improving reliability, onboarding and the demo.

Rules, safety + resource desk

Build boldly, disclose clearly, and leave enough time to submit.

PARTICIPANT RULES

- Solo and team entries are welcome; submit once per team.
- Your project must be judge-accessible and submitted by 18:30 PT.
- Track 2 may use Unity (preferred), VLGE or another engine; disclose the engine and dependencies.
- Judging covers the work built or meaningfully integrated during the hackathon.
- Templates, assets, datasets and AI tools are allowed when licensed and disclosed.
- Do not capture private spaces, identifiable people or behavioral data without permission.
- No harmful, deceptive, harassing, discriminatory or rights-infringing content.
- If a team collects data, it must address consent, provenance and removal of personal identifiers.
- Organizer decisions on eligibility, safety and judging are final.

OFFICIAL LINKS

EVENT + SCHEDULE

BUILD IN V-CTRL

VLGE GUIDE

MAPS + SPLAT GUIDES

UNITY MANUAL

UNITY ROBOTICS HUB

COMPLETE URLS + QR CODES → PAGE 9

Final 30-minute checklist

Freeze features. Run the exact path the judges will run.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Open world/build link in a clean environment | ☐ Confirm credits, consent, provenance and disclosures |
| ☐ Verify spawn, controls, objective and end state | ☐ Submit the Google Form before 18:30 PT |
| ☐ Track 2: test multiplayer + explain the future data plan | ☐ Save confirmation; keep the demo open and ready |
| ☐ Capture backup video + strongest screenshots | ☐ Prepare a one-sentence answer: "Why does this matter?" |

BUILD SMALL. TEST EARLY. MAKE IT MEMORABLE.

Complete link + QR directory

Every URL is shown in full, remains clickable, and is paired with a scannable QR code.



PROJECT SUBMISSION

<https://forms.gle/AgyhxvcXJGFNj9PC8>

CLICK OR SCAN



BUILD IN V-CTRL

<https://vctrl.vlge.com>

CLICK OR SCAN



VLGE GUIDE

<https://world.vlge.com/vlge-guide>

CLICK OR SCAN



MAPS + SHARED RESOURCES

<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1UG9KbSpQp-ntFher2geb4Rf00hTfezuV?usp=sharing>

CLICK OR SCAN



GAUSSIAN SPLAT CAPTURE GUIDE

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1qtf8ghYXmcKncGhKT4uCbrrgGJAcQxBv7Nsm7HP4uPU/edit>

CLICK OR SCAN



GAUSSIAN SPLAT IMPORT GUIDE

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/13ymcrpvhnZbTPPZHcVUSZYzPv30zVAidjfuc7dSnqEA/edit>

CLICK OR SCAN



UNITY USER MANUAL

<https://docs.unity3d.com/Manual/>

CLICK OR SCAN



UNITY ROBOTICS HUB

<https://github.com/Unity-Technologies/Unity-Robotics-Hub>

CLICK OR SCAN